

The texts to Nos. 16, 29, 59 are from Books or Essays indicated, which do not give the source of the quotations.

The authors of the words to Nos. 76, 86, are unknown to the composer or the editor.

Where no author is indicated the words are by Harmony Twichell Ives or her Husband.

Nos. 5, 7, 8, 9a, 16, 20, 30, 40, 42, 44, 45, 46, 47, 62, 66, 94, 98, 99, 100, 105, 107, may be found suitable for some religious services

Nos. 28, 53, 85, 86, 87, 89, 90, 96, have little or no musical value—(a statement which does not mean that the others have any too much of it). These are inserted principally because in the writer's opinion they are good illustrations of types of songs, the fewer of which are composed, published, sold, or sung, the better it is for the progress of music generally. It is asked—(probably a superfluous request)—that they be not sung, at least in public, or given to students except as examples of what not to sing.

Nos. 15, 47, 59, 69, are adapted from orchestral scores.

Nos. 54, 56, are brass-band marches.

Nos. 44, 45, 46 are from violin sonatas.

Greek philosophers, ward-politicians, unmasked laymen, and others, have a saying that bad-habits and bad-gardens grow to the "unintendedables"; whether these are a kind of "daucus carota," "men," "jalis" or mechanistic theories of life" is not known,—but the statement is probably or probably not true. The printing of this collection was undertaken primarily, in order to have a few clear copies that could be sent to friends who, from time to time, have been interested enough to ask for copies of some of the songs; but the job has grown into something different,—it contains plenty of songs which have not been and will not be asked for. It stands now, if it stands for anything, as a kind of "buffer state,"—an opportunity for evading a question, somewhat embarrassing to answer,—"Why do you write so much ———, which no one ever sees?" There are several good reasons, none of which are worth recording.

Another, but unconvincing, reason for not asking publishers to risk their capital or singers their reputations, may be charged to a theory,—(perhaps it is little more than a notion, for many do not agree with it, —to be more exact, a man did agree with it once; he had something to sell,—a book, as I remember, called "The truth about something," or "How to write Music while Shaving!") Be that as it may,—our theory has a name—it is, "The balance of values," or "The circle of sources"; (in these days, of chameleon efficiency, every whim must be classified under a scientific sounding name, to save it from investigation). It stands something like this: That an interest in any art-activity, from poetry to baseball is better, broadly speaking, if held as a part of life, or of a life, than if it sets itself up as a whole—a condition verging, perhaps, towards a monopoly or possible a kind of atrophy of the other important values, and hence reacting unfavorably upon itself. In the former condition, this interest, this instinctive impulse, this desire to pass from "minor to major," this artistic-intuition, or whatever you call it, may have a better chance to be more natural, more comprehensive, perhaps, freer and so more tolerant,—it may develop more muscle in the hind legs and so find a broader vantage ground for jumping to the top of a fence, and more interest in looking around,—if it happens to get there.

Now all this may not be so; the writer certainly cannot and does not try to prove it by his own experience, but he likes to think the theory works out somewhat in this way. To illustrate further (and to become more involved): if this interest, and everyone has it, is a component of the ordinary life,—if it is free primarily to play the part of the, or a, reflex, subconscious-expression, or something of that sort, in relation to some fundamental share in the common work of the world, as things go, is it nearer to what nature intended it should be, than if, as suggested above, it sets itself up as a whole,—not a dominant value only, but a complete one? If a fiddler or poet does nothing all day long but enjoy the luxury of drudgery of fiddling or dreaming, with or without meals, does he or

does he not, for this reason, have anything valuable to express?—or is whatever he thinks he has to express less valuable than he thinks? This is a question which each man must answer for himself. It depends to a great extent, on what a man nails up on his dashboard as "valuable." Does not the sinking back into the soft state of mind (or possibly a non-state of mind) that may accept "art for art's sake," tend to shrink rather than toughen up the hitting muscles,—and incidentally those of the umpire or the grand stand, if there be one? To quote from a book that is not read:—"Is not beauty in music too often confused with something which lets the ears lie back in an easy-chair? Many sounds that we are used to, do not bother us, and for that reason are we not too easily inclined to call them beautiful? . . . Possibly the fondness for personal expression, —the kind in which self-indulgence dresses up an miscalls freedom,—may throw out a skin-deep arrangement, which is readily accepted at first as beautiful—formulae that weaken rather than toughen the musical-muscles. If a composer's conception of his art, it's functions and ideals, even if sincere, coincide to such an extent with these groove-colored permutations of tried out progressions in expediency, so that he can arrange them over and over again to his delight—has he or has he not been drugged with an overdose of habit-forming sounds? And as a result do not the muscles of his clientele become flabbier and flabbier until they give way altogether and find refuge only in exciting platitudes,—even the sensual outbursts of an emasculated rubber-stamp,—a 'Zaza,' a 'Salome' or some other money-getting costume of effeminate manhood? In many cases probably not,—but there is this tendency."

If the interest, under discussion, is the whole and the owner is willing to let it rest as the whole, will it not produce something less vital than the ideal which underlies, or which did underlie it? And is the resultant work from this interest as free as it should be from a certain influence of reaction which is brought on or, at least, is closely related to the artist's over-anxiety about its effect upon others?

And to this, also, no general answer must be given,—each man will answer it for him self—if he feels like answering questions. The whole matter is but one of the personal conviction. For as Mr. Sedgwick says in his helpful and inspiring little book about Dante, "in judging human conduct,"—and the manner in which an interest in art is used has to do with human conduct,—"we are dealing with subtle mysteries of motives, impulses, feelings, thoughts that shift, meet, combine and separate like clouds."

Every normal man,—that is, every uncivilized of civilized human being not of defective mentality, moral sense, etc., has, in some degree, creative insight (an unpopular statement) and an interest, desire and ability to express it (another unpopular statement). There are many, too many, who think they have none of it, and stop with the thought or before the thought. There are a few who think (and encourage others to

think) that they and they only have this insight, interest, etc. . . . and that (as a kind of collateral security) they and they only know how to give true expression to it, etc. But in every human soul there is a ray of celestial beauty (Plotinus admits that) and a spark of genius (nobody admits that). If this is so, and if one of the greatest sources of strength,—one of the greatest joys, and deepest pleasures of men, is giving rein to it in some way, why should not every one instead of a few, be encouraged, and feel justified in encouraging everyone including himself to make this a part of every one's life and his life,—a value that will supplement the other values and help round out the substance of the soul?

Condorcet, in his attitude towards history,—Dryden, perhaps when he sings, “—from heavenly harmony, This universal frame began The diapason closing full in man,”—more certainly Emerson in the “Over-soul” and “common-heart” seem to lend strength to the thought that this germ-plasm of creative-art, interest and work is universal, and that its selection-theory is based on any condition that has to do with universal encouragement. Encouragement here is taken in the broad sense of something akin to unprejudiced and intelligent examination, to sympathy and unconscious influence,—a thing felt rather than seen. The problem of direct encouragement is more complex and exciting but not as fundamental or important. It seems to the writer that the attempts to stimulate interest by elaborate systems of contests, prizes etc., are a little overdone nowadays. Something of real benefit to art may be accomplished in this way, —but perhaps the prizes may do the donors more good than the donees. Possibly the pleasure and satisfaction of the former in having done what they consider a good deed, may be far greater than the improvement on the quality of the latter's work. In fact, the process may have an enervating effect upon the latter,—it may produce more Roderick Hudsons than Beethovens. Perhaps something of greater value could be caught without this kind of bait. Perhaps the chief value of the plan is to establish a “course at Rome” to raise the standard of American music (or the standard of American composers—which is it?) may be in finding a man strong enough to survive it. To see the sunrise a man has but to get up early, and he can always have Bach in his pocket. For the amount of a month's wages, a grocery-clerk can receive “personal instruction” from Beethoven and other *living* “conservatories.” Possibly, the more our composer accepts from his patrons, “et al.,” the less he will accept from himself. It may be possible that a month in a “Kansas wheat field” will do more for him than three years in Rome. It may be, that many men—perhaps some of genius— (if you won't admit that all are geniuses) have been started on the downward path of subsidy by trying to write a thousand dollar prize poem or a ten thousand dollar prize opera. How many master-pieces have been prevented from blossoming in this way? A cocktail will make a man eat more, but

will not give him a healthy, normal appetite (if he had not that already). If a bishop should offer a “prize living” to the curate who will love God the hardest for fifteen days, whoever gets the prize would love God the least,—probably. Such stimulants, it strikes us, tend to industrialize art, rather than develop a spiritual sturdiness—a sturdiness which Mr. Sedgwick says shows itself in a close union between spiritual life and the ordinary business of life, against spiritual feebleness which shows itself in the separation of the two. And for the most of us, we believe, this sturdiness would be encouraged by anything that will keep or help us keep a normal balance between the spiritual life and the ordinary life. If for every thousand dollar prize a potato field can be substituted, so that these candidates of “Clio” can dig a little in real life, perchance dig up a natural inspiration, art's-air might be a little clearer—a little freer from certain traditional delusions,—for instance, that free thought and free love always go to the same café—that atmosphere and diligence are synonymous. To quote Thoreau incorrectly: “When half-Gods talk, the Gods walk!” Everyone should have the opportunity of not being over-influenced. But these unpopular convictions should stop,—“On ne donne rien si libéralement que ses conseils.”

A necessary *part* of this *part* of progressive evolution (for they tell us not that evolution is not always progressive) is that every one should be as free as possible to encourage every one, including himself, to work, and to be willing to work where this interest directs,—“to stand and be willing to stand, unprotected, from all the showers of the absolute which may beat upon him,—to use or learn to use or , at least, to be unafraid of trying to use, whatever he can, of any and all lessons of the infinite which humanity has received and thrown to him—that nature has exposed and sacrificed for him,—that life and death have translated for him,” *until* the products of his labor shall beat around and though his ordinary work,—shall strengthen, widen and deepen all his senses, aspirations, or whatever the innate power and impulses may be called, which God has given man.

Everything from a mule to an oak, which nature has given life has a right to that life, and a right to throw into that life all the values it can. Whether they be approved by a human mind or seen with a human eye, is no concern of that right. The right of a tree, wherever it stands, is to grow as strong and as beautiful as it can whether seen or unseen,—whether made immortal by a Turner,—translated into a part of Seraphic architecture or a kitchen table. The instinctive and progressive interest of every man in art, we are willing to affirm with no qualification, will go on and on, every fulfilling hopes, every building new ones, ever opening new horizons, until the day will come when every man while digging his potatoes will breathe his own Epics, his own Symphonies (operas if he likes it); and as he sits of an evening in his backyard and shirt sleeves smoking his pipe and watching his brave children in *their* fun of building *their* themes,

for *their* sonatas of *their* life, he will look up over the mountains and see his visions, in their reality,—will hear the transcendental strains of the day's symphony, resounding in their many choirs, and in all their perfection, through the west wind and the tree tops!

It was not Mark Twain but the "Danbury News Man" who became convinced that a man never knows his vices and virtues until that great and solemn event, that first sunny day in spring when he wants to go fishing, but stays home and *helps* his wife clean house. As he lies on his back under his the bed,—under al the beds,—with nothing beneath him but tacks and his past life,—with his soul (to say nothing of his vision), full of that glorious dust of mortals and carpets,—with his finger-tips rosy with the caresses of his mother-in-law's hammer (her annual argument),—as he lies there taking orders from the hired girl, a sudden and tremendous vocabulary comes to him. Its power is omnipotent, it consumes everything,—but the rubbish heap. Before it his virtues quail, hesitate and crawl carefully out of the cellar window; his vices, —even they go back on him,—even they can't stand this,—he seems them march with stately grace (and others) out of the front door. At this moment there comes a whisper,—the still small voice of a "parent on his father's side"—Vices and Virtues! Vices and Virtues! They ain't no sech things, —but ther'e a tarnal lot of 'em." Wedged in between the sewing machine and the future he examines himself, as every man in his position should do;—"What has brought me to this?—Where am I? Why do I do this?"—"these are the natural inquiries. They have assailed thousands before our day; they will afflict thousands in years to come and probably there is no form of interrogation so loaded with subtle torture,—unless it is to be asked for a light in a strange depot by a man you've just selected out of seventeen thousand as the one man the most likely to have a match. Various authors have various reasons for bringing out a book, and this reason may or may not be the reason they give to the world; I know and care not. It is not for me to judge the world unless I am elected. It is a matter which lies between the composer and his own conscience, and I know of no place where it is less likely to be crowded. . . . Some have written a book for money; I have not. Some for fame; I have not. Some for love; I have not. Some for kindlings; I have not. I have not written a book for any

of these reasons or for all of them together. In fact, gentle borrower, I have not written a book at all"—I have merely cleaned house. All that is left out on the clothes line,—but it's good for a man's vanity to have the neighbors see him—on the clothes line.

For some such for different reason; through some such or different process this volume,—this package of paper, uncollectible notes, marks of respect and expression, is now thrown, so to speak, at the music fraternity, who for this reason will feel free to dodge it on its way—perhaps to the waste basket. It is submitted as much or more in the chance that some points for the better education of the composer may be thrown back at him, than that any of the points the music may contain may be valuable to the recipient.

Some of the songs in this book, particularly among the later ones, cannot be sung,—and if the could perhaps might prefer, if they had a say, to remain as they are,—that is, "in the leaf,"—and that they will remain in this peaceful state is more than presumable. An excuse (if none of the above are good enough) for their existence, which suggests itself at this point, is that a song has a *few* rights the same as other ordinary citizens. If it feels like walking along the left hand side of the street—passing the door of physiology or sitting on the curb, why not let it? If it feels like kicking over an ash can, a poet's castle, or the prosodic law, will you stop it? Must it always be a polite triad, a "breve gaudium," a ribbon to match the voice? Should it not be free at times from the dominion of the thorax, the diaphragm, the ear and other points of interest? If it wants to beat around in the valley, to throw stones up the pyramids, or to sleep in the park, should it not have some immunity from a Nemesis, a Rameses, or a policeman? Should it not have a chance to sing to itself, if it can sing?—to enjoy itself, without making a bow, if it can't make a bow?—to swim around in any ocean, if it can swim, without having to swallow "hook and bait" or being sunk by an operatic geryhound? If it happens to feel like trying to fly where humans cannot fly,—to sing what cannot be sung—to walk in a cave, on all fours,—or to tighten up its girth in blind hope and faith, and try to scale mountains that are not—Who shall stop it!

— In short, must a song
always be a song!

C.E.I.